ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 1

Chapter 13: **Power-sharing (Political Science)** | Class 10 Social Science | Maximum Marks: 40

SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 10 × 1 = 10

Q.	Correct Option	Brief Reasoning
1	**(a)** horizontal distribution of power	The organs stand at the same level
2	**(c)** Respecting the feelings and interests of different communities and regions	Belgian leaders realised unity needs mutual respect
3	**(d)** French	About 80 per cent speak French and 20 per cent Dutch
4	**(b)** north and east of the country	The map in the chapter shows this
5	**(b)** 1948	Independence from Britain came in 1948
6	**(c)** 74 per cent	Tamil speakers are about 18 per cent
7	**(c)** prudential	Power sharing reduces conflict and gives stability
8	**(b)** moral reason	It values the act of sharing power itself
9	**(d)** 2009	It caused a terrible setback to social and economic life
10	**(d)** checks and balances	Judges, though appointed by the executive, can check it

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 2 = 8

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
11	Through constitutional and legal arrangements that give representation to weaker sections and religious or linguistic groups (1); Example: Belgium's community government or reserved constituencies in India (1).	1+1
12	A belief that the majority community should be able to rule in any way it wants (1); It disregards the wishes and needs of the minority (1).	1+1
13	Competition among parties ensures that power does not remain in one hand (1); Parties may form alliances and run a coalition government together (1).	1+1
14	Dutch speakers were a majority in the country but a minority in the capital (1); Both communities claimed control over it, which made tension more acute (1).	1+1

SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 3 = 12

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
15	Thousands of people of both communities were killed (1); Many families fled as refugees and many lost their livelihoods (1); It caused a terrible setback to the social, cultural and economic life of the country (1).	1+1+1
16	Power sharing is the very spirit of democracy (1); Those affected by the exercise of power have a right to be consulted on how they are governed (1); A legitimate government is one in which citizens, through participation, acquire a stake in the system (1).	1+1+1
17	Constitutional and legal arrangements give weaker sections and minority groups a place in legislatures and administration (1); Example: Belgium's community government (1); Example: reserved constituencies for SC and ST in Parliament and Assemblies (1).	1+1+1
	OR: Power is shared among the legislature, executive and judiciary (1); Each organ can check the others, so none can exercise unlimited power (1); For example judges can check the executive and laws made by the legislature (1).	1+1+1
18	They struggled for Tamil as an official language, regional autonomy and equal opportunity (1); Their demand for more autonomy to Tamil provinces was repeatedly denied, and by the 1980s some groups wanted an independent Tamil Eelam (1); Distrust turned into widespread conflict and civil war (1).	1+1+1
	OR: It is a third kind of government, elected by people of one language community - Dutch, French or German - wherever they live (2); It has power over cultural, educational and language-related issues (1).	2+1

SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
19	Belgium: 59 per cent Dutch, 40 per cent French, 1 per cent German-speaking (2); Sri Lanka: 74 per cent Sinhala speakers, 18 per cent Tamil speakers, about 7 per cent Christians (1); Brussels had a Dutch-speaking minority in the capital; Sri Lanka's Sinhala majority could impose its will (1); Without accommodation, Belgium could have faced a messy partition and Sri Lanka a civil war (1).	2+1+1+1

	OR: Prudential reasons: it reduces conflict and brings political stability (2); Example: Belgium avoided division, Sri Lanka suffered civil war (1); Moral reason: sharing power is the spirit of democracy (1); People affected by decisions have a right to be consulted and a legitimate government gives citizens a stake (1).	2+1+1+1
20	Belgium recognised regional differences while Sri Lanka's leaders sought Sinhala dominance (1); Belgium gave constitutional guarantees to each community (1); In Sri Lanka demands for autonomy were repeatedly denied (1); Tamils turned to struggle, and distrust became civil war (1); Hence power sharing, not domination, keeps a country united (1).	1+1+1+1+1
	OR: The 1956 Act made Sinhala the only official language (1); Preferential policies for Sinhala applicants in universities and jobs (1); The constitution protected and fostered Buddhism (1); Tamils felt that the state ignored their language, culture and equal opportunities (1); This increased alienation and led to demands for autonomy and finally civil war (1).	1+1+1+1+1

Evaluator's note: Award step marks as shown; accept any correct alternative method. In internal-choice questions, evaluate only the option attempted. Deduct up to ½ mark for missing units or figures where required.

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ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 2

Chapter 13: **Power-sharing (Political Science)** | Class 10 Social Science | Maximum Marks: 40

SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 10 × 1 = 10

Q.	Correct Option	Brief Reasoning
1	**(a)** vertical division of power	Higher and lower levels of government are involved
2	**(a)** four times	Four amendments built the new arrangement
3	**(c)** equal	The constitution prescribes equal numbers
4	**(b)** A majority community forcing its dominance undermined national unity	It is the contrasting example to Belgium
5	**(d)** Community government - power shared by social groups	Belgium's community government is the example for social groups
6	**(c)** ethnic	The chapter defines it as a social division based on shared culture
7	**(a)** an independent Tamil Eelam in the north and east	The distrust turned into a civil war
8	**(a)** came from India as plantation workers in the colonial period	They differ from the Sri Lankan Tamils who are natives
9	**(c)** Dutch	Flemish region is Dutch-speaking
10	**(d)** Giving provinces with Tamil populations greater autonomy	The demand for autonomy was repeatedly denied

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 2 = 8

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
11	About 59 per cent live in the Flemish region and speak Dutch, about 40 per cent live in Wallonia and speak French (1); The remaining 1 per cent speak German (1).	1+1
12	A social division based on shared culture (1); Members believe in common descent because of similarities of physical type, culture or both, and need not share religion or nationality (1).	1+1
13	Equal number of Dutch and French-speaking ministers in the central government (1); Regional governments with powers not subordinate to the Centre, or a separate government for Brussels, or a community government (any one more) (1).	1+1
14	Power is shared among organs of government placed at the same level (1); Example: legislature, executive and judiciary (1).	1+1

SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 3 = 12

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
15	It was long believed that power must stay with one person or place for quick decisions (1); In a democracy people are the source of power, so it must be distributed (1); Power sharing in Belgium preserved unity while Sri Lanka's refusal harmed it (1).	1+1+1
16	Belgium shows that unity comes from respecting the interests of all communities (1); Sri Lanka shows that a majority forcing its dominance and refusing to share power undermines national unity (1); Hence power sharing is necessary in democracies (1).	1+1+1
17	It reduces the possibility of conflict between social groups (1); Social conflict leads to violence and instability, so sharing gives stability to the political order (1); Imposing majority will may look attractive in the short run but undermines unity in the long run (1).	1+1+1
	OR: Sinhala was made the only official language in 1956 (1); Sinhala applicants were favoured for university seats and government jobs (1); The constitution protected and fostered Buddhism, so they felt their language and culture were ignored (1).	1+1+1
18	People are the source of all political power (1); People rule themselves through institutions of self-government (1); Diverse groups and views must be respected and everyone should have a voice in public policies (1).	1+1+1
	OR: Parties compete and may form coalitions, so power is shared among them (1); Pressure groups like traders, farmers and workers influence decisions through committees or pressure (1); Citizens can choose among contenders for power (1).	1+1+1

SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers

2 × 5 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
19	People are the source of all political power (1); Respect for diverse groups gives everyone a voice in public policies (1); It lessens social conflict, violence and instability (1); Majority tyranny harms minority and often the majority too (1); Belgium and Sri Lanka illustrate this (1).	1+1+1+1+1
	OR: Among organs of government (horizontal) with checks and balances (2); Among governments at different levels (vertical or federal) (1); Among social groups such as religious and linguistic groups, through reserved constituencies and community government (1); Among political parties, pressure groups and movements through competition, coalition and influence (1).	2+1+1+1
20	Constitution amended four times between 1970 and 1993 (1); Equal numbers of Dutch and French ministers; special laws need majority support from each language group (1); Powers given to regional governments not subordinate to the Centre; Brussels has a government with equal representation (1); Community government elected by language communities (1); It has avoided civic strife and a division on linguistic lines (1).	1+1+1+1+1
	OR: The notion arose from the belief that power must reside in one place for quick decisions (1); In democracy people are the source of power, so it is shared (1); Belgium's sharing strengthened unity (1); Sri Lanka's majority dominance weakened unity and caused war (1); So well-designed sharing makes a country more stable (1).	1+1+1+1+1

Evaluator's note: Award step marks as shown; accept any correct alternative method. In internal-choice questions, evaluate only the option attempted. Deduct up to ½ mark for missing units or figures where required.

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ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 3

Chapter 13: **Power-sharing (Political Science)** | Class 10 Social Science | Maximum Marks: 40

SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 10 × 1 = 10

Q.	Correct Option	Brief Reasoning
1	**(d)** a coalition government	Parties share power directly
2	**(b)** constitutional powers not dependent on the Central Government	Belgium thus moved from unitary to federal
3	**(b)** It reduces the possibility of conflict between social groups	Stability and fewer conflicts are practical gains
4	**(b)** cultural, educational and language-related matters	These are its special powers
5	**(d)** French	Wallonia is French-speaking
6	**(d)** majoritarianism	This is the term the chapter defines for Sri Lanka's policy
7	**(c)** it gave different language communities and regions power instead of letting one dominate	No single community can decide unilaterally
8	**(c)** a majority in the country but a minority in the capital	They outnumbered others nationally but not in Brussels
9	**(c)** influencing decision making in government	They take part in committees or influence decisions
10	**(b)** Sinhala as the only official language	It disregarded Tamil

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 2 = 8

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
11	Power is shared among governments at different levels (1); For example the Union Government, State Governments and local bodies like panchayats and municipalities (1).	1+1
12	A violent conflict between opposing groups within a country (1); It becomes so intense that it appears like a war (1).	1+1
13	Prudential reasons stress better outcomes such as less conflict and more stability (1); Moral reasons stress that sharing power is valuable in itself because it is the spirit of democracy (1).	1+1
14	The 1956 Act recognised Sinhala as the only official language (1); Preferential policies for Sinhala applicants for university and government jobs, or a constitution to protect and foster Buddhism (any one) (1).	1+1

SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 3 = 12

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
15	Belgium shared power among communities and regions (1); Sri Lanka's majority imposed its will through majoritarian measures (1); Belgium avoided a division of the country while Sri Lanka had a civil war (1).	1+1+1
16	Equal number of Dutch and French-speaking ministers in the Central Government (1); Many central powers were given to two regional governments that are not subordinate to the Centre (1); Brussels has a separate government with equal representation, and there is also a community government (1).	1+1+1
17	They recognised regional differences and cultural diversities (1); They amended the constitution four times between 1970 and 1993 (1); Unity of the country was possible only by respecting the interests of every community (1).	1+1+1
	OR: Constitution clearly lays down the powers of different levels of government (1); A general government for the whole country and governments at provincial level share power (1); In India these are the Union, State and local governments (1).	1+1+1
18	Power sharing reduces the possibility of conflict even in small, undivided societies (1); It is the spirit of democracy because those affected have a right to be consulted (1); So it is not needed only in societies with divisions or only in big countries (1).	1+1+1
	OR: A government formed when two or more parties come together (1); They contest elections as an alliance or join after elections (1); It shows power being shared among political parties (1).	1+1+1

SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks

19	Citizens must be free to choose among contenders, so parties compete (2); Competition ensures power does not remain in one hand (1); Alliances can form coalition governments and share power directly (1); Interest groups such as traders, industrialists, farmers and workers influence decisions or sit on committees (1).	2+1+1+1
	OR: After the civil war leaders agreed on rules for sharing power among communities (1); The President must be a Maronite Christian and the Prime Minister a Sunni Muslim (1); The Deputy Prime Minister is an Orthodox Christian and the Speaker a Shi'a Muslim (1); Christians agreed not to seek French protection and Muslims not to seek unification with Syria (1); Elders see it as the guarantee of peace though some, like Khalil, dislike it (1).	1+1+1+1+1
20	Legislature, executive and judiciary exercise different powers at the same level (2); Each organ checks the others, so ministers answer to Parliament and judges can review executive action (1); Vertical sharing is among Union, State and local governments (1); The constitution lays down the powers of each level (1).	2+1+1+1
	OR: Constitutional and legal arrangements represent weaker sections and women in legislatures and administration (2); Belgium's community government shares power among language groups (1); India's reserved constituencies give space to diverse social groups (1); This gives minority communities a fair share and prevents alienation (1).	2+1+1+1

Evaluator's note: Award step marks as shown; accept any correct alternative method. In internal-choice questions, evaluate only the option attempted. Deduct up to ½ mark for missing units or figures where required.

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